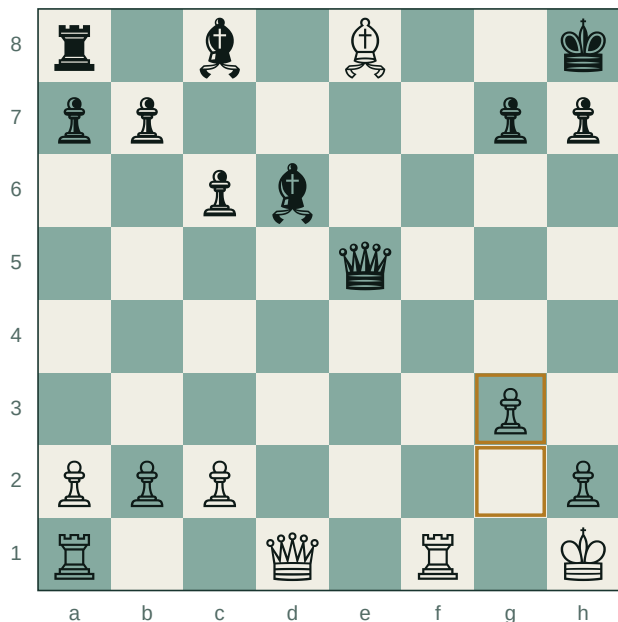


# Forks and double attacks: Black, move 17

Forks and double attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 17.g3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**17...Qe4+ 18. Qf3 Qxe8**

**17...Qe4+** Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From e4 it attacks king on h1 and bishop on e8. Recorded reply: **18.Qf3**.

**18...Qxe8** The queen captures the bishop on e8.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on e8. Check for tactical protection.